

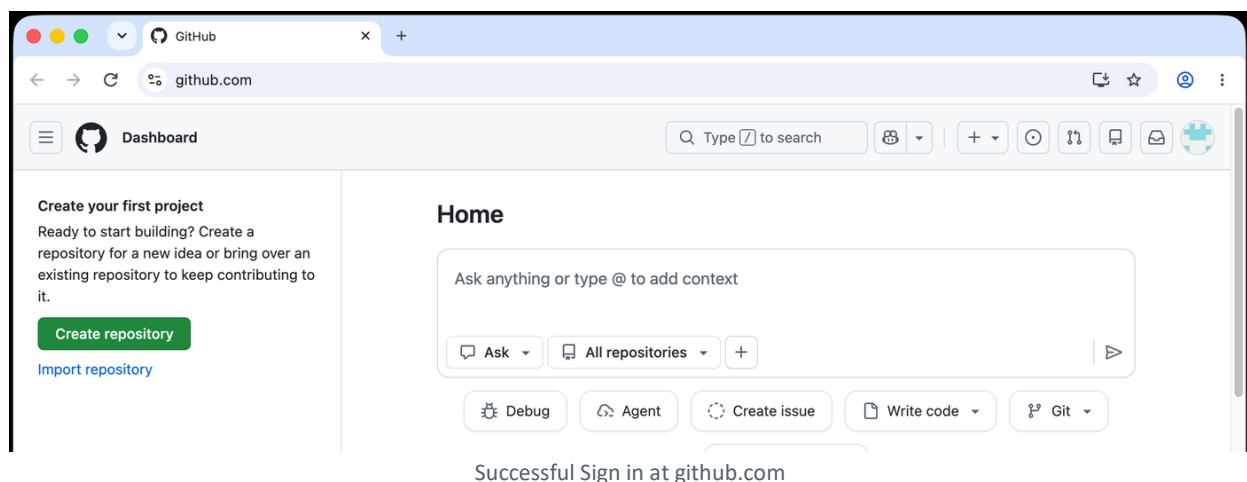
Lab 2 – Setting Up GitHub Copilot on VS Code

Overview

- To vibe code a dashboard for a dataset, you need to use an AI-powered coding assistant. Examples include:
 - o GitHub Copilot
 - o Claude Code
 - o Cursor
- One proper way to vibe code is to use GitHub Copilot in VS Code:
 - o VS Code is a professional code editor.
 - o GitHub Copilot allows you to vibe code on VS Code conveniently.
- This document provides the steps to use GitHub Copilot on VS Code. We need to do the following:
 - o Create a GitHub account
 - o Subscribe GitHub Education (Optional)
 - o Install VS Code
 - o Set-up GitHub Copilot on VS Code

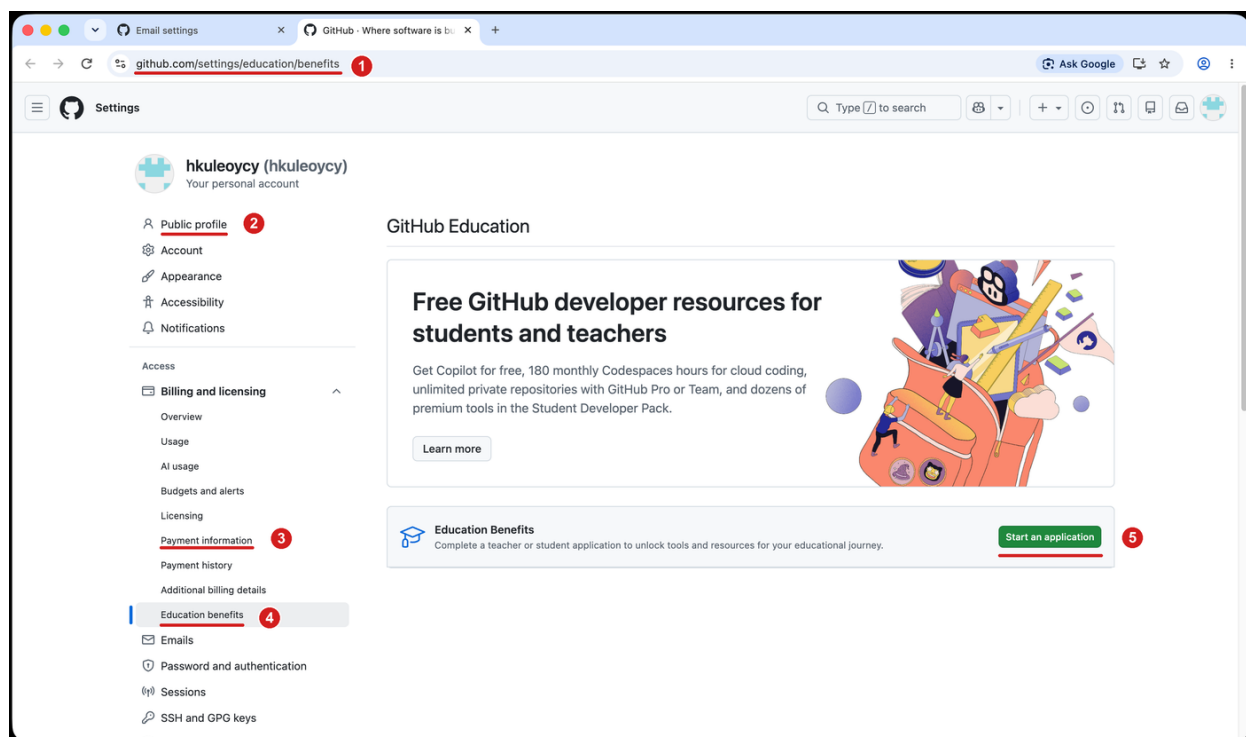
1) Create a GitHub Account

- Create a GitHub account on <https://github.com/>
- Pick a professional username. It appears on everything you commit in future projects / jobs.



2) Subscribe GitHub Education

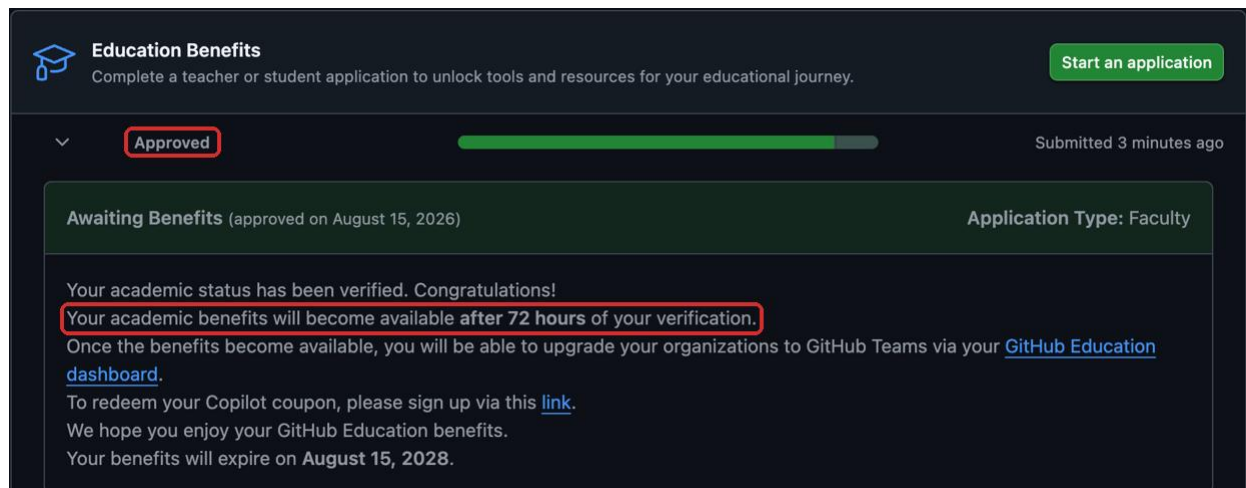
- OPTIONAL — You can still vibe code with GitHub Copilot without subscribing to GitHub Education. However, we would strongly recommend you subscribe to it (FREE for HKU students) and earn these benefits:
 - o Larger AI usage allowance than the free tier.
 - o 180 hours of Codespaces a month — a full dev machine in the browser.
 - o GitHub Pro, plus the Student Developer Pack: dozens of paid tools free for students.
- To get a subscription of GitHub Education, you need to prove that you are a student. Applications can be rejected for silly reasons. Therefore, get these four things done BEFORE you start applying for a subscription:
 - o Your HKU email is verified on the account. Go to Settings → Emails to fill in your school email address. GitHub reads the domain and fills in your school for you.
 - o Two-factor authentication is ON. HKU is on the list of schools that require it, and you cannot complete the registration form without it.
 - o Your full name (same as your student card) appears in BOTH Settings → Public profile AND Settings → Billing → Payment information (If you change your name, log out and back in, or GitHub keeps using the old values).
 - o Location sharing is allowed — in the browser AND in macOS Location Services — and you are physically in Hong Kong.
- To apply for a subscription, go to Settings → Billing and licensing → Education benefits → "Start an application". Choose Student. Note that you do not need a credit card to complete the subscription.



- 1 The address: github.com/settings/education/benefits
- 2 Public profile — your full legal name goes here BEFORE you apply
- 3 Payment information — the SAME name again; the application checks both
- 5 "Start an application" opens the form

- Start the application. In the process, it will ask you for proof by camera: You will need your HKU student card showing your name, the school, and the expiry date.

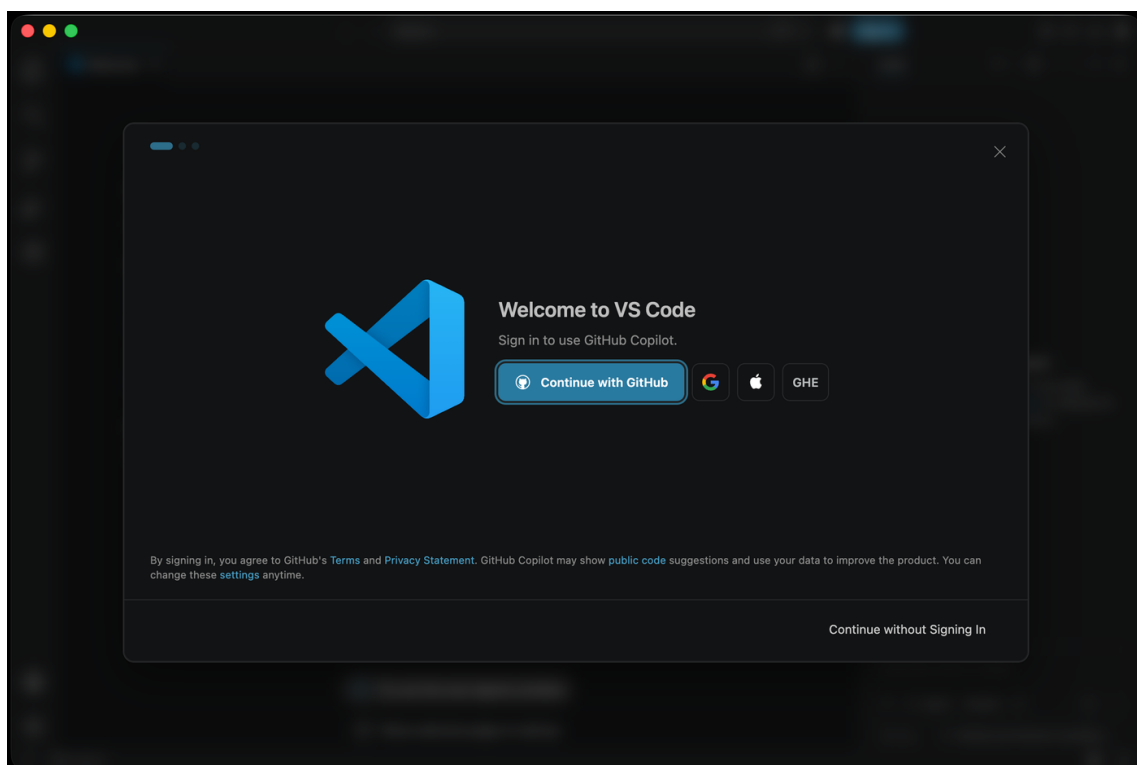
- Approval is not instant: A new account often waits days to get approved. Once it says Approved, the benefits themselves arrive up to 72 hours later — so apply now, not the week you need Copilot.



The screen after you subscribe GitHub Education successfully

3) Install VS Code

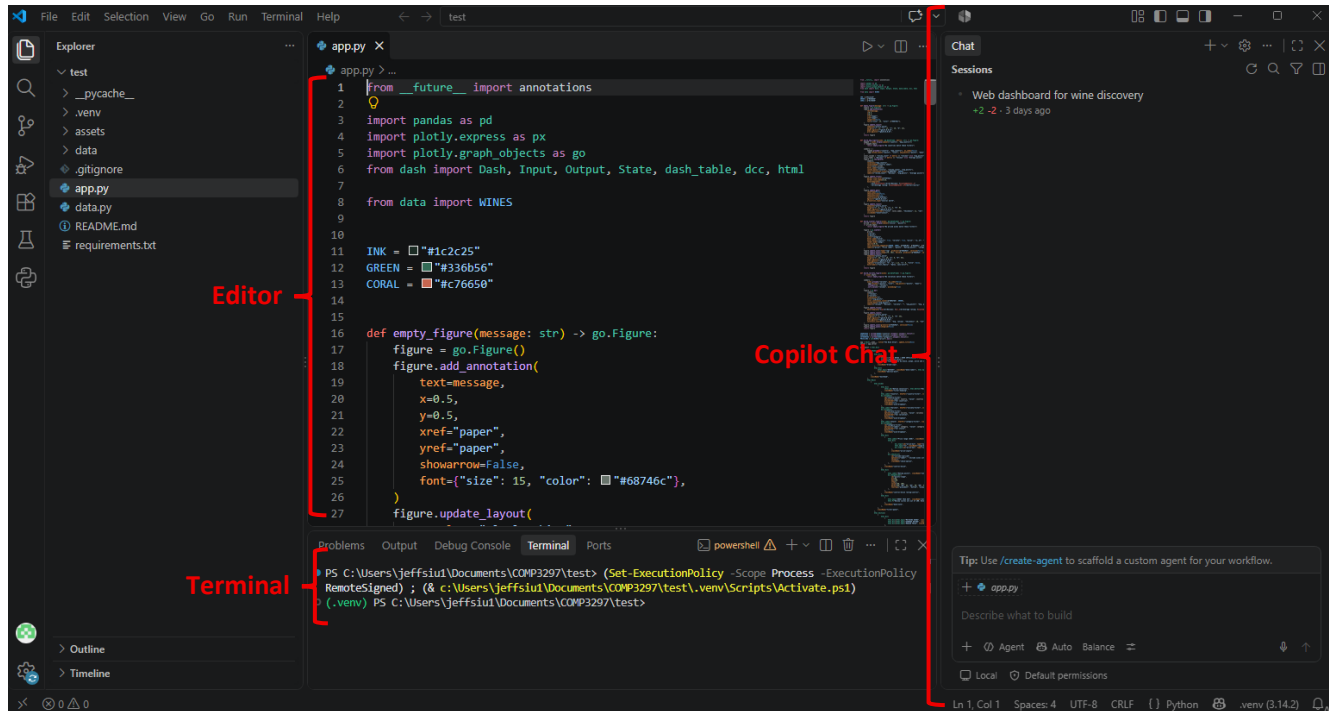
- Download the installer for VS Code from <https://code.visualstudio.com/>. Follow the instructions to complete installation.
- Open VS Code after installation. On first launch it offers a sign to GitHub — do it, with your GitHub account.
- The sign-in turns on GitHub Copilot. There is nothing to install: Copilot and Copilot Chat ship inside VS Code.
 - o The free tier allows 2,000 usages of AI-assisted code generation per month, plus chat with agent mode.



What you see at first launch of VS Code. Sign in with GitHub.

4) Setting Up VS Code Interface Properly

- You need to open three important tools in your VS Code interface:
 - A code editor
 - A terminal at the bottom. To open it, go to View → Choose “Terminal”.
 - A GitHub Copilot Chat. To open it, go to View → Choose “Chat”.

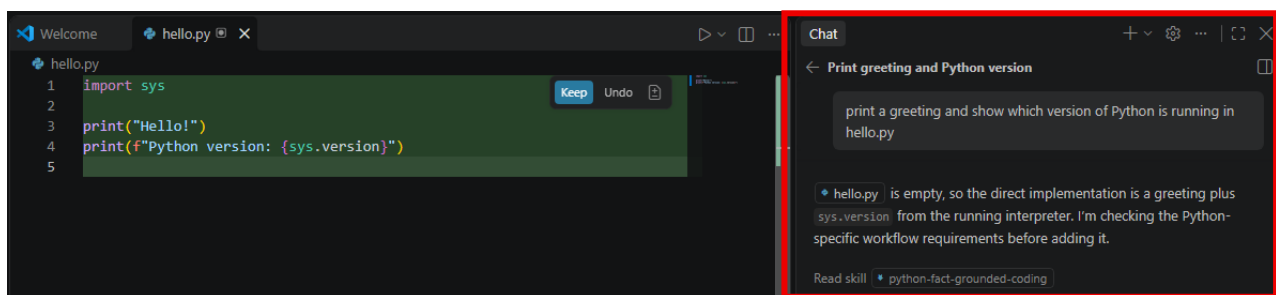


The screen after you set-up VS Code interface correctly

5) See if GitHub Copilot Works

- Open a new project folder inside VS Code. Do this by File → Open Folder → New Folder.
- Create a new file: hello.py
- To ask AI writing code inside the file (i.e. Vibe Code), execute the following prompt in Copilot Chat:

print a greeting and show which version of Python is running in hello.py



Ask Copilot to Vibe Code

- Copilot will generate the code for you by AI. Click “Keep” to keep the code AI generates for you.

- You can also try to run the code by clicking the “Play” button and see what pops up in the terminal.



The screenshot shows the Visual Studio Code interface. At the top, a file named 'hello.py' is open. The code in the editor is:

```
1 import sys
2
3 print("Hello!")
4 print(f"Python version: {sys.version}")
5
```

In the top right corner of the editor, there is a 'Play' button (a right-pointing triangle) which is highlighted with a red box and a red arrow pointing to it from the word 'Play'.

Below the editor is the 'Terminal' panel. It shows the command prompt output after running the script:

```
PS C:\Users\jeffsiu1\Documents\t> & c:\python314\python.exe c:/Users/jeffsiu1/Documents/t/hello.py
Hello!
Python version: 3.14.7 (tags/v3.14.7:823f032, Aug 5 2026, 10:51:32) [MSC v.1944 64 bit (AMD64)]
PS C:\Users\jeffsiu1\Documents\t>
```

The terminal output after you run hello.py

- Now, you can follow the instructions in “Lab2 – Vibe Coding (Plotly and Dash) + Structuring a Narrative” to vibe code a dashboard by using GitHub Copilot on VS Code!!!